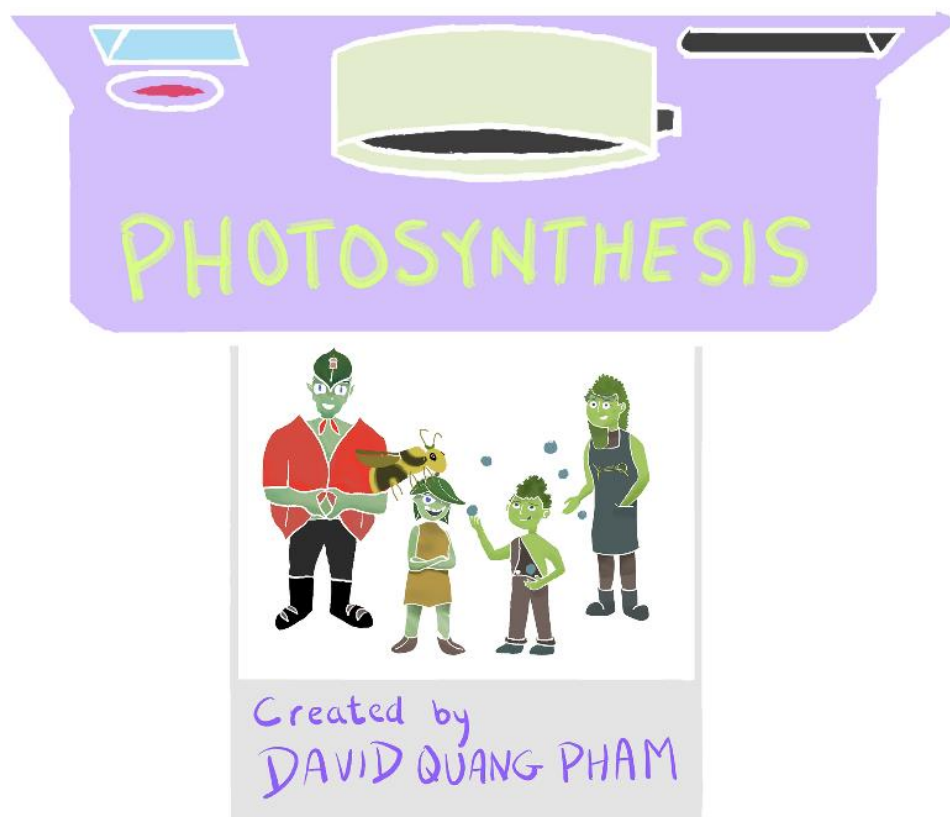




Written by and Music by
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Based on the musical ***Turnover: A New Leaf*** by
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PROLOGUE

INT. TERRACOTTA CUSTOMS AND SOIL PROTECTION OFFICE

A polaroid camera snaps. It prints a photo of RAU RAM, 30s, a Cilantro whose earthly hair and tan gleam but has vermilion hands. Pregnant, she is expecting a new seed.

RAU (O.S.)
Green Card?

RAU's vermilion hands pull the photo off the camera.

RAU (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Oh... a photo...

THROUGH THE CAMERA: RAU leans against a wall in a terracotta pot-esque Customs and Soil Protection (CSP) biometric office. She is underneath a banner that reads: "Photosynthesis."

RHIZO BLOMQUIST, a CSP Officer and eventual Secretary of Garden Security, takes the photo off RAU's hands and puts it in RAU RAM's case file. RAU has RHIZO display RAU's case file for us to see through the camera.

This 1995 Woodwork citizenship application shows that RAU was born in Vuon (Vietnamese: "Garden"), age 30s, a Cilantro ethnicity, a red leaf fingerprint, and a pending green card.

RAU extends a hand. RHIZO dismisses the handshake and exits.

RAU turns us (the camera) around to reveal...

EXT. CAMERA STORE IN THE AIRPORT - DAY

THROUGH THE CAMERA: ...a camera store where RAU made her first purchase: a polaroid camera and tripod! She already unboxed them and set them up. She takes her first own photo.

RAU (CONT'D)
Photosynthesis!

EXT. DIRTY CITY - DAY

THROUGH THE CAMERA: we are now at the welcome sign of Dirty City, Woodwork. She clumsily adjusts the camera and runs towards the welcome sign. She positions herself, trying to seem cool while the local plants walk by with scorn eyes.

RAU (CONT'D)
Photosynthesis!

FLASH!

EXT. DIRTY CITY - TOWN SQUARE - DAY

THROUGH THE CAMERA: we are now in a bustling town square with a fountain. She runs to and poses by the fountain.

RAU
Photo-

CRACK! Someone knocked us (the camera) over.

EXT. DIRTY CITY - STREET - EVENING

RAU carries around the broken camera with a protruding photo.

The locals put up signs that read: "Curb the Herb." RAU walks by sheer disapproval. With each unwelcoming gesture, she sinks lower. She does not belong on this soil.

EXT. FIG LEAF - DUSK

The sun sets as RAU collapses. RAU is too exhausted for tears. She finally pulls the photo out of the polaroid.

The photo is her pregnant belly. She is here for one reason.

RAU (CONT'D)
My seed...

MALUS (O.S.)
Mercy?

RAU turns away from the sunset to face a vibrant nightclub.

The door opens, revealing an apple in their 40s named MALUS CRABAPPLE. Their red attire is fabulously angelic.

RAU
Chào. Aren't you an angel?

MALUS
Hello. Aren't all Figs?

RAU
Hell! Any Fig is a malice!

MALUS
Dat's my name: Malus Crabapple. I
am a Fig-

MALUS extends a hand. RAU slaps away MALUS.

RAU
Figment of my imagination. Get your
appendages off me!

MALUS

Reality! Gotta hand it to you. You
are no angel. You ain't owed a safe
haven. You don't belong on our soil.

RAU

Heavens. Your kind soiled safety.

MALUS

And your kind of soil is mud.

RAU

Mud is where you're most safe...

MALUS

Dirty or clean... **A green card
ain't green on the other side.**

RAU

Already better than growing up
playing red cards I'm dealt with.

MALUS

But, the other side of the ocean
had the right conditions for you.
There ain't no unconditional love
in our Dirty City.

RAU

The Woodwork dream...

MALUS

Is this what you imagined it to be?

RAU

This Cilantro dreams! *Bleeds!* I
believe this city needs its
garnishes. Imagine Dirty City's
first-ever salon. I *know* of a
better life for my family here...

MALUS

You immigrants got wild dreams. *But
imagination*s. You cannot imagine my
people living in peace with your
family, wherever yours come from.

RAU

You don't know where I come from.

MALUS

Like a leaf, Figs are always
floating around the world. Your
tone ain't a *brussels* sprout's.

RAU

Well, your attitude is CRAP!

MALUS

Watch your language!

RAU

CACA! Pardon my French. I do not have a tone! I went to a Woodworkan-sponsored school to get the Vuonese out of my system...

MALUS

Well you look like you took a leave from Southeast Asia? All your last names are like weed (re: *Nguyen*)?

RAU

Răm. Rau Răm. Lots more last names in Vuon. And no. You know nothing about life out there.

MALUS

Rau, I ain't judge ya days. Don't judge my night-

RAU

I know not of where your nightlife comes from.

MALUS

It stems from birth.

RAU

This lifestyle you have, you are not born with it. You chose this light. You are not natural. I can't imagine a life without light.

MALUS

You keep this up and your salon stays an imagination. Your story will end here.

RAU

I cannot keep my stems up. No plot of land in Dirty City will ever let me plant myself. I moved this far for what? My story will... What?

"MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD" SONG

MALUS walks over to the empty plot of land next door. They pull the tarp away to unveil fresh soil.

MALUS
MOVE THE PLOT... FORWARD...
MAKE YOUR ROOTS AT HOME

RAU
THIS IS YOUR BEST FOOT FORWARD?

MALUS
ROOT FOR ME...

RAU
IM LANG (Vietnamese: "Shut up")

MALUS
MAKE YOUR BED

A tanning bed rolls out.

RAU
SHUT UP

MALUS
I WASN'T BORN WITH LIGHTHEARTEDNESS
I HAVE CHOSEN IT

NOW YOU CHOOSE:
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...

RAU
OR...?

MALUS
(Repeating)
LEAVE THE PLOT HOLE...
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...

RAU reluctantly plants herself.

RAU
WHOLE...

RAU & MALUS
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD...

RAU FORWARD! MALUS YOU'RE WHOLE!

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

The plot thickens. The land develops into the Salontro salon.
An Open/Closed sign faces "Closed." A tanning bed descends.

RAU
Im lang. Im lang. Im lang! Im lang!

MALUS

A tanning bed is an interesting
plot device.

RAU

I prefer the sun, but that will do.

MALUS

*I can't take anymore of your deep
gratitude, transplant.*

RAU

We bleed the same eukaryotic cells.

MALUS

Indeed, then treat me like I do.

RAU

I treat you how you treat a wallet.

MALUS

Dat's the start of a plot.

MALUS hands a manure-laced bill. They get in the tanning bed.

RAU

IT'S THE TURN OF AN ERA!
I WAS DEALT A BAD HAND
THIS AREA HAS NO REGARD
THEY TREAT ME AS AN ALIEN
I HAVE GROWN THESE LEAVES THAT
COULDN'T EVER HOLD THIS WATER
I WAS GONNA COME APART
BUT I GUESS YOU DO HAVE A HEART
I HAVE A NEW START

MALUS gets out of the tanning bed.

RAU (CONT'D)

Turn around. Nice tan. Nothing fancy.

MALUS

Not a fan. You'll see dat fancy
gets the fans. I'll try to get my
pals en root. You're on your own on
this soil. It's ya turn from here.

MALUS turns the "Closed" sign to "Open" before exiting.

TUMBLEWEEDS dance in and out.

RAU

I CAN'T EARN MY GREEN CARD
IF I DON'T STAY ON MY GUARD.

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)
MY LEAVES HAVE COME SO FAR.
YOU CAN'T MAKE ME LEAVE!
ALL THAT REMAINS ARE MY ROOTS,
FAMILY...

RAU pulls out body oil and rubs her belly with it.

RAU (CONT'D)
Seems the most proper maternity
gift is reality.

PARSLEY (V.O.)
(Echoing from beyond)
TURN AROUND!

We hear positive murmurs. FigLeaf patrons stop by Salontro.
With the rising and setting sun, financial quarters roll by.
Business is booming. More tanning beds roll out. Money rains.

RAU
My body oil? You like this foreign
stuff? Well, it's no fertilizer!
This oil is not found in Dirty City.
It's from my dirty ol' village!

YOU HAVE MADE IT.
TURN AWAY FROM YOUR OLD LIFE.
YOUR BED IS MADE.
TURN AWAY FROM THEIR WILD NIGHT.

THIS DIRTY CITY IS OUR HOME.
THE NEIGHBORS, THEY'LL KNOW
TO STAY IN THEIR ZONE UNLESS THEIR
TONES...
TURN OVER AND CHANGE FOR THE
BETTER.

MALUS steps in, unimpressed with RAU's success.

RAU (CONT'D)	MALUS
(Deceptively)	(Doubtfully)
THIS IS THE START OF...	THIS IS THE START OF...
A BUSINESS PARTNERSHIP.	A BUSINESS PARTNERSHIP.
A "FRIENDSHIP" WHERE I CAN'T	A "FRIENDSHIP" THAT SOWS MAD
KEEP MY GUARD DOWN.	SEEDS IN OUR GARDEN.

MALUS gathers money and leaves the rest to RAU. They exit.

RAU turns the sign to "Closed." She hides in a tanning bed.

RAU (CONT'D)
BUT THE BEST TURNOVER I'VE EVER
HAD...

RAU gets out. Her belly is no more.

Sunlight lands on another tanning bed, leading to a 11-year-old cilantro named PARSLEY leaping out of it.

RAU (CONT'D)
...IS MY SUN!

PARSLEY
MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD!

END OF "MOVE THE PLOT FORWARD"

RAU (CONT'D)
Turn around... You missed a spot.
But son, do you shine...

RAU holds PARSLEY's green hands.

PARSLEY
Me (Vietnamese: "Mom")... Don't
embarrass me in front of the
sneezeworts!

PATRONS plant their faces on Salontro windows.

RAU
Us Cilantros are all about
presentation. Parsley Răm is a
natural. Organic. Woodwork.

ACT I

INT. SALONTRO - DUSK

RAU sits PARSLEY on a tanning bed. She clips his hair.

RAU
But your trichomes getting
unnaturally long.
(Repeating, interspersing)
I love you. I love you lots.

PARSLEY
(Repeating, interspersing)
I love you. I love you more.

RAU
What is the airspeed velocity of an
unladen dandelion seed?

PARSLEY
30 centimeters per second. No more
math problems-

RAU
Square root of a boxwood tree?

PARSLEY

I'll learn square roots when I
start middle school in the fall.

RAU has PARSLEY face a mirror.

RAU

Is this worthy of a Flores
Elementary graduate?

PARSLEY

Gym class would have a good laugh.

RAU

With this cut, they'd actually pick
you before the Cherries.

PARSLEY

Dodgeball's an Apple's sport anyway-

RAU

You need your root canals checked.
Speaking of Apples, how is ceremony
planning going?

PARSLEY

It's been fruitful! Ms. Red's
partner treated us to CO₂.

RAU

That's delightful. Who is he?

PARSLEY

Her name is Golden Delicious. She
is an archaeologist.

RAU

Oh, *she* is... *She*...

PARSLEY

Ms. Red's final lesson was that Fig
weddings are more fabulous than any
other kind.

RAU

Schools should not be teaching that
to minors! They should teach major
subjects. The Sunshine Garden state
doesn't teach math nor science.

PARSLEY

History!

RAU

Here's a story: seedlings exist
only because stamens and pistils
love one another.

PARSLEY

A kid at recess once told me that
love is like the legendary tale of
the bird and the bee.

RAU

Kids fall for so many rumors these
days. Plus, those don't add up.
Birds and bees don't go together.
It's bird plus bird. Bee plus bee.

Dance music is heard outside, so PARSLEY sits by the window.

PARSLEY

Ugh, math. Something's buzzing at
FigLeaf.

RAU

The Figs are hosting another party.
You can always count on that.

PARSLEY

Mom... Who goes out at night?

RAU

A light with no sense of direction.
And your light needs to go to bed.

RAU opens a tanning bed and plants a blanket in it.

RAU (CONT'D)

Your planter's made. Now lie in it.

PARSLEY

Will the sun always be around?

"A NATURAL" SONG

RAU

NATURE...

NURTURED FROM THE LIGHT OF OUR SUN
IT'S NATURAL

PLANTING THEIR HOT FEET ON OUR
GROUND
THEY'RE NATURAL
BUT IT'S NOT AS WARM AS A MOM'S HUG

RAU hugs PARSLEY.

RAU (CONT'D)
COMES NATURAL
WHAT'S NOT? THAT'D BE THE TICKLES!

RAU tickles PARSLEY.

RAU (CONT'D)
A NATURAL... IS TRUE TO THEMSELVES.
SON. YOU ARE A... NATURAL!

END OF "A NATURAL"

PARSLEY
I am a natural at lying.

RAU
You speak the truth, my son.

PARSLEY
Mom. I wonder who'll be my moon...

RAU
Ngu ngon (Vietnamese: "Sleep
well"), my son.

EXT. SALONTRO - DUSK

The sun sets behind Salontro.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. MT. WOODWORK - DAWN

The sun rises behind a rural town of Mt. Woodwork, Woodwork.

EXT. PYRUS'S HOUSE - DAWN

In view, there is a tree-like house and a pond.

INT. PYRUS'S BEDROOM - DAWN

It is a teenager's bedroom, full of posters and instruments.
A 14-year-old pear named PYRUS is sleeping in their bed.

BOMBUS, a pet bee, is sleeping on PYRUS's face. Once the
sunlight touches BOMBUS, they buzz like an alarm.

BOMBUS
Buzz! Buzz! Buzz! Buzz!

PYRUS
Buzz... off!

PYRUS throws BOMBUS into their hive bed. PYRUS is tired.

INT. PYRUS'S BATHROOM - DAWN

PYRUS looks in the mirror. PYRUS is disheveled, whose face is full of teenage acne and mind is full of teenage angst.

INT. PYRUS'S LIVING ROOM - DAWN

On the table are stacks of envelopes and letters that detail PYRUS's multiple suspensions from school and their mother's letter to their unty Malus about staying over the summer.

EXT. PYRUS'S POND - DAWN

PYRUS dives into the pond. They hear nature judging them.

NATURE
(Repeating and echoing)
You will never amount to
anything...

PYRUS soon runs out and sobs. BOMBUS rushes to their side. Their antennae wipes away PYRUS's tears.

EXT. PYRUS'S HOUSE - SHORTLY AFTER

A bus waits in front of the home. PYRUS comes out with their luggage. They wave goodbye to BOMBUS watching from a window.

PYRUS takes a seat in the bus and sees BOMBUS partying in PYRUS's bedroom. PYRUS looks on, disapprovingly.

And on the bus goes.

WOODWORK

The map of Woodwork is displayed. The country resembles the writer's home state, Michigan. The upper peninsula resembles a giant leaf while the lower resembles a tree trunk.

PYRUS's bus is going from Mt. Woodwork in the upper peninsula to Dirty City in the lower peninsula.

EXT. DIRTY CITY - DAY

The bus drives by the welcome sign of Dirty City.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

A mail truck drives into Salontro's mailbox, crushing in.

ANCHOR (O.S.)
Breaking news out of Woodwork.

A MAILPERSON steps out to assess the damage. They cannot put an envelop in the mailbox, so they decide to head inside.

ANCHOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Every transplant is illegal...

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

RAU intently watches WoodTV8 news on a TV. They show footages of migrant TRANSPLANTS thrown into CSP vehicles.

ANCHOR (O.S.) (CONT'D)
...under the Weed Out Act that's now ratified and set in motion. Any transplant not carrying a Green Card will have to get one soon.

By the end of the summer, CSP - Customs and Soil Protection - will even start detaining those with pending applications.

The TV shows successful applicants whose non-green hands turn green when they obtain their Green Cards.

RAU
It's been 12 years... This has got to be an April Fool's Day joke.

RAU is irked by the TV chyron that reads: "This is April 2."

The MAILPERSON enters and hands RAU the envelop.

It is from Customs and Soil Protection and marked: **URGENT.**

On TV, RHIZO is at the podium, speaking to REPORTERS.

RAU (CONT'D)
That's the government plant that never shook my hand...

REPORTER (O.S.)
Secretary of Garden Security Rhizo Blomquist, Woodwork is home to thousands of unadapted transplant-

RHIZO (O.S.)
Woodwork's government has made clear that the statutory term is "invasive species."

REPORTER (O.S.)
Woodwork is home to invasive spec-

RHIZO (O.S.)
Woodwork is no home to invaders.
That answers that. Now, I ask the
questions. What's your paper?

REPORTER (O.S.)
Noticias de El Arbol.

CSP agents surround the REPORTER.

REPORTER (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Yo yo yo! I'm on a journalism visa!

RHIZO (O.S.)
Woodwork citizens are protected by
the Leaf of Rights. You are not.

REPORTER (O.S.)
Por favor, I got two kids born here-

RAU watches PARSLEY sweep the salon floor.

RHIZO (O.S.)
Too bad too sad. Those two orphans
will find loving homes away from
law-breaking invasive species. With
no Green Card, you have no place on
our soil. You do not belong-

RAU turns off the TV with a green remote. She looks at her
vermilion hands, compared to the green remote.

PARSLEY
What's wrong, mom?

RAU freaks out and flings the remote, shattering it.

RAU
Umm... *The delivery person forgot a
package.* It's a... NEW REMOTE!

MAILPERSON
You're speaking to a seasoned
veteran of New Leaf Delivery. I
ain't never forget nothing.

RAU
*You sure you didn't delivery it to
the wrong address?*

MAILPERSON
What other place is named *Salontro?*

RAU
(Whispering to MAILPERSON)
Can you play along? I don't want my
son to worry.

MAILPERSON
Look, cilantros. I'd play ball with
a plant who has a Green Card. But,
I ain't complicit in no crime with
the likes of you, transplant.

MAILPERSON exits. RAU follows.

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

MAILPERSON sits in their truck, moisturizing themselves.

MAILPERSON (CONT'D)
I worry about you, Rau. I'll miss
your scented moisturizers. These
make carrying them paper cutters
worth it.

RAU
That's the missing moisturizer I
had shipped from Vuon months ago!

MAILPERSON swiftly drives off and hits another mailbox.

RAU just notices her crushed mailbox. She almost has a mental
breakdown then calmly worries about what's in the envelop.

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

PARSLEY is cleaning. They notice a bus stop by FigLeaf.

PYRUS steps off the bus.

RAU steps in front of PARSLEY's sight.

RAU
Delivery messed up. I'll be back.

RAU exits.

PARSLEY sees the bus drive away.

PARSLEY
This delivery is perfect...

PARSLEY is glued to the window.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)
I'll have your back.

MALUS enters Salontro.

MALUS
Where's your mom?

PARSLEY
Our delivery... went remote... to
the wrong address. So, she's out
getting it.

MALUS
Strange. She's usually out to get
me. I kid, you Cilantro.
Nevertheless... Cow, Parsley.

PARSLEY
Chào. You Crabapples are always
sweet, but you can never sweeten
your pronunciations?

MALUS
I'm a certain bi, not bilingual.

PYRUS (O.S.)
No, Malus. / No malice.

MALUS
Yes, Pyrus!

PARSLEY
Pyrus?

MALUS
My nibbling.

PARSLEY
Another Crabapple?

MALUS
The pear's in town.

PYRUS (O.S.)
And I wanna get outta this Dirty
City.

PARSLEY
Doing our city dirty? You'll fit in
real well.

MALUS
Tanning beds come in all shapes and
sizes. And there gotta be one dat
matches your body, Pear.

PYRUS (O.S.)

I don't want nobody to see me
around ya, crazy unty Apple. Let's
go back to FigLeaf!

PARSLEY

I always wanna visit FigLeaf.

MALUS

Now, you may have the spirit of a
Fig. But only adult plants are
allowed at nightclubs. And, *your*
mother would lose her freakin'
aldehyde.

PYRUS (O.S.)

Ya said ya'd take me to Cantaloupe
Outlets, not make this salon my
outlet...

MALUS

You will never find me among those
hipsters. How about a trip to
Celery Mall?

PYRUS (O.S.)

But ya said we could go where I
wanted! You're more of an Apple
Blossom than a Crabapple. Celery
Mall only sells to old houseplants.

MALUS

Take dat back!

PYRUS (O.S.)

Per FigLeaf's policy: No returns.
No, Malus.

MALUS

Nothing's returnable in a
nightclub, Pyrus... You're digging
a deeper hole for yourself.

PYRUS (O.S.)

Ain't dat what we're supposed to do
as plants?!

MALUS

Even plants can get overheated.

PARSLEY

You're all making a mountain out of
a molehill.

PYRUS (O.S.)
Shadeeee. Ya can burn us. But, ain't
nothing can top a sunburn.

"AMOUNT TO ANYTHING" SONG

PYRUS walks in with sunburns and green palms. Their entrance
is like a teenage rocker with acne.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
MOUNTAINS OUTTA MOLE HILLS.
NO REST. DISTRESSED. A MESS.
CARELESS.

I DELIVERED BRUISES AND I GOT INTO
TROUBLE AT SCHOOL.
SO, I'LL SPEND THIS SEASON WITH MY
ONE WEIRD UNTY.
I WON'T KNOW MALUS...

ALL BECAUSE REALLY
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
I WILL NEVER AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
ANYTHING!

SUNBURNS. PIMPLES. ACNE. BIG DEAL.

I AIN'T ALWAYS THIN-SKINNED, BUT MY
THICK SKIN HAS NOT LOOKED REAL
COOL.
SO, I'LL WASTE MY SUMMER NEXT TO A
CILANTRO.
I CAN'T GIVE A MORSAL...

ALL BECAUSE IN LIFE,
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
I CARE NOT TO AMOUNT TO ANYTHING.
I DON'T CARE!

ANYTHING!

END OF "AMOUNT TO ANYTHING"

DIRTY CITY - TOWN SQUARE - DAY

RAU sits on the fountain, anxiously holding the envelop. She
sees in the water a reflection of herself in her 30s.

RAU
Everything. I'm losing everything.

RAU opens the envelop and reads the letter.

RAU (CONT'D)
(Reading)
Rau Ram... Your green card
application is now under review.

RAU relaxes.

RAU (CONT'D)
12 years...

MALUS (O.S.)
That's a good age to take care of
your daily skincare!

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

PYRUS
What, to get an artificial tan?

MALUS
And where else can you get one
other than the Salontro!

PYRUS
I want a *natural* tan!

MALUS
We're not the only families
susceptible to sunburns. The
Cherrys and Maples are, too.

PARSLEY
Our tanning beds can be set at any
level most comfortable with you.

MALUS
See, Pyrus. Parsley's always level-
headed.

PYRUS
I'm gonna level with ya Cilantros:
ya can spice up my skin, but it
ain't ever spice up my life.
(to MALUS)
Don't look at me. I'll meet ya back
at FigLeaf.

MALUS
Ya seedlings enjoy yourselves!

MALUS exits.

PYRUS

I ain't no seedling anymore, Malus!
Do ya thing, little herb.

PARSLEY leads PYRUS around the tanning beds in Salontro.

PARSLEY

High pressure tanning beds?

PYRUS

I ain't letting no middle schooler
pressure me.

PARSLEY

No pressure at all. Where do you go
to school?

PYRUS

Tetra Hill Conservatory.

PARSLEY

TH Conservatory in the U P? That
school's rich enough to not have a
resource officer.

PYRUS

Eat poop with ya *lower peninsula*
mindset... Trolls under the bridge.
Right, it ain't stop other flowers
from being fashion polices.

PARSLEY

What did these upper peninsula
Yoopers do?

PYRUS

They get under my membrane. They
overreacted.

PARSLEY

To...?

PYRUS

Me shutting down the school's power
grid... So they ain't look at me no
more.

PARSLEY

My classmates would think you're
loads of fun!

PYRUS

What do middle schoolers even do
for fun?

PARSLEY

Mudwrestling and singing in the
rain!

PYRUS

I'm not sure what to make of it.
Fun or not, in the end, I'm the one
who shuts the party down.

PARSLEY

A rose and thorn for you.

PYRUS

Don't get me started on the roses.
They are mean and the brighter
fashion police.

PARSLEY

How?

PYRUS

They go beyond outer body shaming.
Their thorns reach my core. My
nucleus.

PARSLEY

Your nucleus needs to toughen up.

PYRUS

My nucleus needs to grow thorns,
like them.

PARSLEY

You pears need to stop comparing
yourself to others.

PYRUS

Easy for ya to say. Ya haven't gone
through puberty yet, little herb.

PARSLEY

You'll grow out of anything. It's
all dandy.

PYRUS

Wow, rich coming from a middle
school poop head.

"GROW A PAIR" SONG

PYRUS (CONT'D)

YA NEED TO GROW UP.

PARSLEY
TWO CAN PLAY AT THAT GAME!

PYRUS
YA AIN'T CRAP.

PARSLEY
I AM THE CRAP.

PYRUS
YA ARE

PARSLEY & PYRUS
A NUMBER TWO.

PYRUS
GROW UP, HERB.

PARSLEY
GROW UP, PEAR!

PYRUS
I NEED TO GROW ONE?

PARSLEY
YOU GOT SKIN IN THEIR GAMES.

PYRUS
I AIN'T THICK.

PARSLEY
HIGH SCHOOL AIN'T CRUD.

PYRUS
I NEED

PARSLEY & PYRUS
TO FACE THE HEAT.

PYRUS
STOP COMPARING...

PARSLEY
GROW A PAIR.

PYRUS gets into a tanning bed. After the magic, they get out.

PYRUS
HERB... THIS AIN'T NATURAL.
DUDE! I FEEL POWERFUL.

PARSLEY
YOU PEARS.

PYRUS
I AM STILL GROWING.

PARSLEY
WE *BOTH* NEED TO GROW UP.

CILANTROS. PYRUS

PARSLEY
AND CRABAPPLES.

PARSLEY & PYRUS
WE DO MAKE A GREAT

TEAM.	PARSLEY	SMOOTHIE.	PYRUS
-------	---------	-----------	-------

PYRUS (CONT'D)
NOT SO SMOOTH...

PARSLEY
LET'S GET SOME FOOD!

PARSLEY shares fertilizer popsicles with PYRUS.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)
HERE'S TO GROWING UP!

PYRUS
FERTILIZER NEVER...?

PARSLEY
GETS TOO OLD!

PYRUS
DEFINITELY!

PARSLEY
YOU KNOW WHAT IS COOL IS THAT

PARSLEY & PYRUS
WE'D MAKE A GREAT PAIR.

END OF "GROW A PAIR"

PYRUS pulls out a glass bottle.

PYRUS
Let's test our water.
(Scaring PARSLEY)
Alcohol's only fifteen percent...

PARSLEY
I can't drink that.

PYRUS
Why not?

PARSLEY
I'm not old enough.

PYRUS
I ain't either. But I'm fine. *I feel old enough.* And I'm like only a few years older than ya. Besides, this is worth 72 B S. You're old enough to count dat high?

PARSLEY
You don't need to spew much. Look, it's on me. If you feel bad about it, I'll take a few bull.

PYRUS
Nah, I need to save every B S I can, so I can finally cut off my carbon-dated parents.
Ya heard my life with the flowers at school. Now imagine dat but 72 times dat at home.
Just a sip. You'll feel right at home.

PYRUS opens the bottle.

PARSLEY takes a sip. He spits out.

PARSLEY
It's a *miracle* I got any taste of barley piss.

PYRUS
Dat's the name of the liqueur!

PARSLEY
Barley piss?

PYRUS
Ewwwww, no. Miracle! Well, looks like our friendship is gonna go against the grain.

PARSLEY
Friends?

PYRUS

Miracle and I, silly herb! And now
dat we're friends, friends go
shoppin' together!

PARSLEY

Can Miracle tag along?

PYRUS

*Miracle needa stay a no-show or
we'll be tagged as criminals by the
po-po. Don't start poop!*

PARSLEY

Wash your mouth out with soap!

PYRUS

Wash yours with Miracle! I'm
rooting for ya, Parsley.

PYRUS takes the bottle. They exit.

"TEST THE WATER" SONG

PARSLEY enters this newfound state of tasting alcohol for the very first time. The lake forms. The tides rise. PARSLEY wobbles. He stays put and yet also journeys to far-off lands. He breaks in his sea legs. He slowly passes out.

PARSLEY

(Repeating)

Glucose is clear. *Glucose clear.*

End of "TEST THE WATER"

INT. SALONTRO - LATE NOON

RAU enters.

RAU enters with a box of body oils. She goes to help PARSLEY up.

RAU

Have you got any pride, son?! Get
up, it's "pride" month! Today is
our pride special!

PARSLEY

(Dizzily)

Did you get the goods, mom?

RAU

Good grief, son...?

PARSLEY
(Dishonestly)
*I may have caught a fungal
infection.*

RAU
I dab antifungal ointment on you
everyday... Now's not the day to
sell yourself short. Speaking of
infection...

RAU dons some rainbow gear. She stops PARSLEY from wearing
them.

Multicolor patrons rush the space.

PARSLEY
Fun guys all around! Happy Pride!

RAU
Happy Pride! Get thirty-one percent
off your order when you wear
Salontro merch at checkout! Buy our
rainbow gear! Parsley... Upsell
these by sixty-nine percent. Sell
sell sell!

PARSLEY
Made from the bees' knees, these
body oil will do more for you this
Pride Month. At just several B S
more than our plain oils, your
knees will be buzzing in no time.
(Leveling with a child)
Kids and short knees like me get a
discount!

RAU
You're indoctrinating the kids?!

The patrons stop moving.

RAU (CONT'D)
Don't count your blessings,
Parsley... Um...
(to the Patrons)
In trade, kids need to be treated
as adults. Discounts are handouts.
And we're unlike other businesses
who refuse to serve you and take
your B S. Although, *it is allowed
under national law.* Here at
Salontro, we'll always support your
unnatural lifestyles.

The lights flicker in disapproval.

PARSLEY
You were born this way!

The multicolor lights move about.

RAU
*That quote always work. Happy
Pride! Love your fit. Happy Pride!
So floral. Happy Pride! Tis the
season for a gay apparel. Happy
Pride! Thank you for supporting
small business owners. Happy Pride!
Immigrant family-owned business.
Happy Pride! That looks so natural
on you!*

As the products run out, PARSLEY turns the "Open" sign to
"Closed."

RAU (CONT'D)
*Son, at the center of every rainbow
is green. These Figs and their B S
are unnatural! Happy Pride...
Hahahaha!*

RAU trashes her rainbow gear. She counts money.

PARSLEY
*Geez, mom. Get a room! You're more
tender to legal tender than your
own son! It's unnatural.*

RAU
*Unlike you, I don't pocket it! I
donate all this B S to non-profits,
like Moms for Canopy.*

PARSLEY
*They got nothing better to do than
to bully my classmates and ban our
books... Poop heads!*

RAU
*Where did you learn to say those
foul words?!*

PARSLEY
*You need to lower the volume
whenever you watch your boring tv
show at night.*

RAU

Don't you dare say that about *Green Lotus*. By the way, why were you sleeping on the job? I'm going to garnish your wages.

PARSLEY

You're gonna make my allowance fabulous?

RAU

No... Though, *your joke is a garnish in itself*.

RAU sees the knocked over herb.

RAU (CONT'D)

Is this some kind of joke?! No no no... Why is my brother knocked over?

PARSLEY

That is not a person...

RAU

Yes, he was!

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

That is a model.

RAU (CONT'D)

Yes, he was a modelled plant, *until he hung out with the Figs*.

PARSLEY

My uncle?

RAU

Anh (Vietnamese: "Brother"). He would have laid off the booze...

PARSLEY

Booze?

RAU

His addiction to Figs led to the booze which laid him off from work and society. He was the light of our lives that went dark too soon.

PARSLEY

Did my grandparents do anything to stop it?

RAU
They did their darneest to protect
him from the unnatural. He was a
person 'til he became a Fig.

PARSLEY
There's nothing your parents
could have done.

RAU (CONT'D)
I'm already a better parent
than they ever were.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)
*A better parent would let me get
some rest.*

RAU
Okay. You've been laid off.

PARSLEY
I need a vacation.

RAU
Where would you like to go?

PARSLEY
Cantaloupe Outlets.

RAU
That trashy Woodworkan shopping
center? Well, we can stop by and
grab some ingredients at their
intimate Vuonese supermarket.

PARSLEY
You like the butcher?

RAU
Someone's got to split water into
oxygen. Besides, he and I are just
old friends.

PARSLEY
I made a new friend...

RAU
Is it a classmate from Ivy League
Junior High? Son, you're finally
making friends! Name?

PARSLEY
Pyrus.

RAU
Where are *they* from?

PARSLEY

The town of Woodwork in the Upper Peninsula.

RAU

Pyrus is coming out of *the* Woodwork...

PARSLEY

And they made Salontro their first visit!

RAU

Did *they* try out a tanning bed? Ooh, which one?

PARSLEY

All of them.

RAU

Wow. In town for a day and already our number one customer.

PARSLEY

Yes. And I wanna get to know our number one customer at the business of all businesses: Cantaloupe Outlets.

RAU

Why can't you be friends with the Cruciferous?

PARSLEY

Ew... Those family of Broccolis are lame.

RAU

What is your two's plan at Cantaloupe Outlets?

PARSLEY

We're gonna go see *Popcorn*.

RAU

Oh no. That movie is for adults. And besides, I don't need you to have nightmares about what heat does to corn. It's not a pretty sight...

PARSLEY

There's no kernel of truth in what you said.

RAU hands money to PARSLEY.

RAU
Here's twenty B S for VeggieTales.

PARSLEY
Shucks. You are so corny-

RAU
Their fanbase is hard to tolerate.
That reality show is a religion to
them. But, they know what's natural
and not.
(Quoting a VeggieTales
song)
"GIVE ME THAT OLD TIME RELIGION."

PARSLEY
God, you don't even believe in a
higher farmer-

RAU
Well, the gospel music...
"IT'S GOOD ENOUGH FOR ME."
Gravity created the Universe. The
food court is pricy, so I packed
carbon and a watering can.

Godspeed. Now, go get yourself
ready as a plum.

RAU hands a food container and a watering can to PARSLEY.

PARSLEY hides in a tanning bed. The other tanning beds
disappear.

ACT II

EXT. CANTALOUPE OUTLETS - DAY

The tanning bed turns into a photo booth. Clothing racks
scatter. PARSLEY sits inside the photo booth as PYRUS enters
and joins in.

"PHOTOSYNTHESIS" SONG

PARSLEY
GET YOUR BUTT IN THE PHOTO BOOTH.
WE'RE GONNA TAKE A LITTLE BREATHER.

PYRUS
BREATHE IN, BREATHE OUT.

PYRUS drinks from a watering can.

PARSLEY
MAKE SURE THAT YOU STAY HYDRATED.
WE'RE GONNA DRINK LOTS OF WATER.

PYRUS
H 2 O.

PARSLEY
NOW GET YOURSELF SITUATED.
WE'RE GONNA MAKE TONS OF SUGAR.

PYRUS
SWEET MEMORIES.

PARSLEY
SIX CARBON DIOXIDE!

PYRUS
AND PLUS...
SIX WATER MOLECULES.

PARSLEY & PYRUS
PUT IT UNDER LIGHT.

PARSLEY C 6 H 12 (TWELVE) O 6... PLUS 6 O 2. GLUCOSE, GLUCOSE, GLUCOSE, AND STARCH. THIS IS PHOTOSYNTHESIS. PHOTOSYNTHESIS.	PYRUS SUGAR, SUGAR, SUGAR, AND STARCH. 6 CARBON 12 HYDROGEN 6 OXYGEN... PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES. CARBOHYDRATE!
--	--

PARSLEY pulls many ingredients.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
YOU'RE OVERREACTING.

PARSLEY
I WANNA GOOD PRODUCT.

PYRUS
YOU'LL GET BYPRODUCTS.

PARSLEY BI...?	PYRUS (CONT'D) SUGAR RUSH!
------------------------------	--

PARSLEY and PYRUS dance the sweetest of dances.

SUGAR, SUGAR, SUGAR, AND STARCH. 6 CARBON 12 HYDROGEN 6 OXYGEN... PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES. CARBOHYDRATE!	PARSLEY (CONT'D)	C 6 H 12 (TWELVE) O 6... PLUS 6 O 2. YOUR CELLULOSE. YOUR CELLULOSE. WE WRITE: PHOTOSYNTHESIS. PHOTOSYNTHESIS.	PYRUS (CONT'D)
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The space displays the equation: $6CO_2 + 6H_2O \rightarrow C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2$.

PARSLEY and PYRUS hand juices to patrons around the mall.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

C 6
 H 12 (TWELVE)
 O 6...
 PLUS 6 O 2.

 6 CARBON
 12 HYDROGEN
 6 OXYGEN
 PLUS 6 OXYGEN MOLECULES.

 PHOTOSYNTHESIS.
 PHOTOSYNTHESIS.
 PHOTO!

The photo booth flashes and prints a photo of a cilantro and pear.

PARSLEY and PYRUS exit the booth.

END OF "PHOTOSYNTHESIS"

The MAYOR strolls in and out, sipping the juice.

MAYOR

Mayor Canna Blomquist here to
 remind you: sugar and water are a
 privilege, not a right for green
 card holders.

PYRUS

We needed dat breather. Redoing the
 photo scene in that movie was so
 much fun! Good thing it was rated
 PG-12, little herb.

PARSLEY & PYRUS

Rotten Tomatoes is the all-time
greatest movie!

PYRUS

It deserves to win the Raspberries.

PARSLEY

I'd certify that it was *freshhhh*.

PYRUS

Well, I hate the scene where
despite the kids' fruits of labor,
they ended up diced tomatoes.

PARSLEY

Can I have another sip of Miracle?

PYRUS tucks away a hidden bottle.

PARSLEY stays put with a sour face.

PYRUS

It was hard enough hiding this
bottle in a dark theatre. Don't
expect me to pass it in broad
daylight. Quit the sour face, sour
grapes. No whining about wine
either.

PARSLEY

You're as square as diced
tomatoes...

PYRUS

Oh, I'm the square?!

There is a mannequin in queer fashion with heels and a crop
top. PARSLEY and PYRUS mock one another until they run into
the mannequin.

MAYOR

Watch out for the mannequin!

PARSLEY

Huh?

PYRUS

Looks like you're the square.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)

I'm no square...

PYRUS

Just checking. Boobs come in all
shapes and sizes. Go ahead. Milk
this moment, little herb.

PARSLEY

Aren't these for...?

PYRUS

They're not just for flowers like me. But these would be perfect for our summer solstice rave!

PARSLEY

What's a rave?

PYRUS

A party where everyone smells like Asparaguses.

PARSLEY

I wanna go! But Malus is gonna be there...

PYRUS

It'll be the summer solstice. Malus will be going on their annual camping trip.

PARSLEY

Who's in charge?

PYRUS

Mari, our security guard.

PARSLEY

Juana? Haha. They always sleep on the job.

PYRUS

They know better than anyone else how to get through the day. I 'dress them as ya "highness."

PARSLEY

In that case, your highness: Raves are for me!

PYRUS

I'm gonna lay down some *ground rules*.

PARSLEY

"Ground rules" sounds like another song!

PYRUS

No time. Rule number one: no kids allowed.

PARSLEY points to himself.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
Bedtime's dusk. No kid can handle
all nighters.

PARSLEY
The night is short during a summer
solstice!

PYRUS
I still don't think ya can, little
herb.

PARSLEY
You're not so big either.

PYRUS
Well, the music is gonna be for
little big flowers like me. We have
a famous guest DJing.

PARSLEY
What's their name?

PYRUS
It's a secret. But the DJ certainly
loves shouting their name at the
top of their stomata to start a
song. Such a weird vegetable.

PARSLEY
Pyrus, is this half-shirt the key to
adulthood?!

PYRUS
Only if ya can top mine!

"CROP TOP" SONG

PYRUS wears a crop top.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
(Repeating)
NOW, IT'S YA TURN.
PICK A PATTERN.

PARSLEY soon picks a t-shirt.

PYRUS nabs and drops the shirt.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
NO NO. RETURN!

(MORE)

PYRUS (CONT'D)
THE CREAM OF THE CROP DAT IS
FASHION.
NO SHIRT CAN EVER TOP THIS!

PARSLEY reads the crop top tag.

PARSLEY
A CROP TOP...?

PYRUS
WHERE TO FIND ONE DAT FITS?
WEAR ONE DAT SUITS YA PERSONALITY.

PYRUS plays with their belly.

PARSLEY
THERE GOES YOUR BELLY.

PYRUS
YA CANNOT BE STOPPED WHEN YA PUT
YOURSELF IN THIS CROP TOP!

PYRUS puts a crop top on PARSLEY.

PARSLEY
IT FEELS SO WARM YET SO COOL...

PYRUS
IT CUTS TO YA HEART'S BOTTOM.
IT HAS YA FEELING ON TOP!
YA CANNOT BE STOPPED WHEN YOU'RE
DANCING IN ROCKING CROP TOPS!

PARSLEY
I TOP YOURS!

PYRUS
YA BOTTOM FEEDER!

PARSLEY
I'M ON TOP!

PYRUS (CONT'D)
I'LL CROP YOU!

PYRUS chases PARSLEY around. The mannequin becomes the mirror reflection of PARSLEY. PARSLEY sees the mirror reflect the queer plant he could truly be someday.

PYRUS (CONT'D)
YOU'RE THE TOP OF THE CROP TO TOP
IT ALL OFF!

PARSLEY
(Blushingly)
NO ONE PULLS THEM OFF LIKE ME...

PARSLEY, PYRUS, and the mannequin suit up in their crop tops.

PARSLEY & PYRUS & MAYOR
CROP TOP!

The mannequin phases into PARSLEY.

END OF "CROP TOP"

EXT. CINEMA AT CANTALOUPE OUTLETS - DAY

MALUS runs out of the cinema at Cantaloupe Outlets while RAU tails MALUS. She holds a popcorn bucket filled with water.

RAU
You cropped my profits!

MALUS
See a prophet about your problems.
Quit stalkin-

RAU
Salontro has lost stock of 72 B S
worth of UVA lamps due to short-
term excessive use.

MALUS
Apply for seed funding from
grassroots orgs!

RAU
Immigrant-owned businesses are less
likely to be approved for seed
funding than others.

MALUS
You pick data like a Cherry.

RAU
I am not cheery about these
maintenance costs!

MALUS
Why don't you appreciate what's
afforded to you, you transplant!

RAU
I'm no trans, Fig.

MALUS
*Let's transition away from the
topic. It ain't the end of the
world like dat disaster movie, Soil
and Green.*

(MORE)

MALUS (CONT'D)

What we just watched: *Popcorn*. Ah, such cinema! Nothing can change my mind about that foxy eggplant cameo, oh honey.

RAU

Don't honey me, *honeycrisp critic*.

MALUS

You're no film critic. Why are you here?

RAU

Well not to talk business. I dropped my son off.

MALUS

And you stayed to get into Parsley's business?

RAU

You have no business going to the movies alone.

MALUS

I was dropping my nibbling off. Then, I needed a half-baked blockbuster to clear my mind about watching over a teenager this entire summer.

RAU

Someone's got to pop the thought of what it is like raising children into your aldehyde-

RAU finds and picks up the potted photo by the photo booth.

PARSLEY

I'm down to go... But I'm not up for that rave.

PYRUS

Nothing can top this. You'll be ready for it.

MALUS

Love dat reminder dat I've done everything?

RAU & MALUS

We've been neighbors for years in...

	RAU	MALUS
Business.		
Home.		

RAU & MALUS
(Disingenuously)
I trust you.

RAU
(re: the photo of PARSLEY
and PYRUS)
Looks like my brother when he was
younger...

MALUS
Don't bring up dat tragic story
again.

RAU
I cared for him as your sister
cares for you.

MALUS
Aww... A photosynthesis of my nib
and your kid-

RAU
Parsley told me that a seedling
stopped by and use all our tanning
beds. *It was your species.*

MALUS
Horse poo!

RAU
They tanned and dashed.

MALUS
I loaned- I mean gave them enough
to cover seven appointments... You
sure your Parsley didn't stash the
B S?

RAU
How could you frame my son?

MALUS
Picture this: they're about a teenager now, growing into adulthood, and their top priority is B S. Like all teenagers!

RAU approaches PARSLEY and PYRUS.

RAU

Son, I'm gonna crop your top off!

PARSLEY

Me (Vietnamese: "Mom")?!

RAU

The plants around this outlet are watching a Cilantro make a scene. Pull it off now!

MALUS

You're the Cilantro always making a scene, Rau.

(Complimentary)

You're pulling off dat crop top, Parsley.

PYRUS

This little herb is on top of the world. His plot is going places.

RAU

Im lang, đồ vô học (Vietnamese: "Shut up, you uneducated person")!

MALUS

Parsley, whatcha mom say? I ain't heard this insult before.

PARSLEY

Me... (Vietnamese: "Mom") You're the ignorant one. *Con đĩ* (Vietnamese: "Insult")!

MALUS

(to RAU)

Look at you foaming at your stomata mouth!

PYRUS

Ha! Whatever ya said. I can't believe ya said it. Ya son of a-

RAU slaps and drags away PARSLEY.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

You jerk...

RAU

(Heartbroken)

Thang chỗ đê (Vietnamese: "Son of an insult")...

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

Uh, Malus is the *thang chố đê* whose family tree is shaped like a circle. End this scenery at once!

PYRUS

I'm rooting for ya, Parsley!

PARSLEY

Mom. As you've said: "*A natural is true to themselves.*"

RAU

(Mad as a Vietnamese mother)

A natural?! You're not true to yourself. What you and Pyrus are doing... It is unnatural!

"SOILED (THE FAMILY NAME)" SONG

RAU (CONT'D)

ARE YOU OUT OF YOUR ALDEHYDE?
WHY CAN'T YOU LEAVE THE PUBLIC'S EYE?
WILL YOU LEARN YOU'RE NEVER RIGHT?
DON'T YOU EVER EVER LIE!

PARSLEY

CAN I LIVE WITHOUT HAVING TO HIDE?
MAY I MAKE MY BED WHERE I DECIDE?
DO I HAVE ANY SORT OF RIGHTS?
TIL THEN, I WILL ALWAYS LIE!

RAU

I won't let you lie six inches under like your uncle!

YOU ARE GROUNDED FOR LIFE!

TOY WITH ME
AND I WILL FEED YOU TO PESTS.
YOU BURY OUR KIN IN SHAME,
AND YOU WILL MEET OUR ANCESTORS IN DEATH!

SOIL OUR NAME
AND I WILL RAIN HELLFIRE!
YOU HAVE NO ONE ELSE TO BLAME.

ARE YOU LISTENING, PARSLEY RĂM?
I'M SO TIRED...

MALUS hugs PYRUS.

MALUS
I AM SO PROUD!

NO RESPECT.
SHE HAS NONE AS SHE IS FAKE.
SHE'S THE ONE WHO SOILED HER NAME,
MAKING OTHER IMMIGRANTS LOOK LIKE
SNAKE PLANTS!

PARSLEY
How did "Parsley" slither into your
mind?

If you did not want me to conform
to the ecosystem, why did you give
me a Workworkan name like
"Parsley?!"

Me, *soil the family name*... Who was
it that didn't give me a foreign
name like you, Rau?!

RAU
Anh thanh niên (Vietnamese: "Young
man"), "gay."

PARSLEY
Young men cannot stay grounded!
Thanks for the validation. I am no
longer a seedling. Gay. *Happy*. I
don't want it any other way.

RAU
YOU ARE A CRIME.
DON'T MAKE ME CRY.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)
I'M AT MY PRIME.
I FEEL LIKE DY-

RAU (CONT'D)
(Repeating)
YOU SOILED...

MALUS
(Repeating)
IN THE NAME...

PARSLEY
(to RAU)
IN THE NAME OF FAMILY, I GAVE
YOUR LIFE SOIL!

MALUS (CONT'D)
(to PYRUS)
IN THE NAME OF FAMILY, YOU
GAVE OUR LIVES SOIL!

PARSLEY hides in the photo booth.

MALUS buys the crop top and exits.

END OF "*SOILED (THE FAMILY NAME)*"

RAU
We're soiled inside...

PYRUS

Get outta his personal space, ya
invasive species-

RAU

You've got some xylems calling me
that! Pyrus... Who taught you to
address me this way?

PYRUS

Malus says ya are who ya are.

PYRUS exits.

RAU looks upon her plain hands.

RAU

(Soliloquizing)

This Dirty City needs to know: I
love my seed. I know the future can
stem more from these new
opportunities than anything my past
roots have offered me. I don't want
the money. I need the green card
that comes with it. But, dealing
with the Figs' B S must not be the
only way. I wither witnessing my
son be a daisy rather than staying
sturdy.

Parsley sees freedom with each
passing dawn. Cori Anh, my brother,
had the same sights. Free will
quenched his insatiable thirst,
then drowned him in his final dusk.
His so-called "brothers in branches"
encouraged this. If only the
biochemicals, the conversion
therapy had shocked him out of his
truth!

This time, I am taking care of it
as a sister-turned-mother. I don't
got to worry about how my life will
play out because I'll play games
night and day. But my son, playing
with these creatures of the night,
will soon find himself never again
seeing the light of day. Unlike his
uncle, I will save him from the Fig
life style full of pain and
heartache. I'm sick to my stoma,
thinking about a life so unnatural.

(MORE)

RAU (CONT'D)

This Dirty City wishes for me to
stop being invasive. Only if your
Figs would stop invading my nerves
and my son's heart. Now pay no
mind.

RAU exits.

The photobooth transforms into a bed and the outlet into
Salontro.

INT. SALONTRO - NIGHT

"FERTILE" SONG

The tanning bed holds a soiled blanket, where PARSLEY pops
out.

PARSLEY

THE WORLD REVOLVES AROUND MORE THAN
YOUR SON.
WHY CAN'T YOU SEE THAT?
AN HERB WHO NEEDS THEIR PLANT
FRIENDS.
PLANET, TOPPED OFF WITH CROPS AND
VEGETABLES.
YOU DON'T SEE MY PRODUCE-
IT IS TRULY FUTILE.

IN THIS "SOILED" FAMILY,
I AM MEANT TO GET DIRTY, REAL
DIRTY.
HOW ELSE WILL I EVER BEAR FRUIT?
I AM FERTILE.
VOLATILE!

FIGLEAF WOULD NEVER DEFER MY SMILE.
A CLEAR COMMUNITY WHO WOULD ACCEPT
ME AND ALL...
THE WHILE MOM KILLS ME TO PUT IT
MILDLY.
THIS WILL BE MY TRIAL.
I'M WILDER THAN A CHILD.

AM I TO SNEAK OUT?
MY MAMA...
THIS WILL NOT HELP ME COME CLEAN,
WITHOUT MEANS.
MY DROP WILL NOT BE SO FRUITFUL.

PYRUS

IT AIN'T FUTILE!

PARSLEY looks out the window. PYRUS is outside.

PYRUS (CONT'D) PARSLEY
LET'S GET WILD! RECONCILE!

PYRUS (CONT'D)
YOU BELONG IN AN OPEN FIELD.

PARSLEY
I LONG FOR WHAT'S QUEER AND
ANYWHERE SO SURREAL.

PYRUS tosses a crop top to PARSLEY.

PYRUS
WEAR THIS BEFORE IT GOES OUT OF
STYLE.
YOU HAVE MADE ME REALIZE: IN LIFE,
IT IS NEVER FUTILE...

PARSLEY trashes his nightlight. He climbs out of the window.

PARSLEY
I AM FERTILE!

END OF "FERTILE"

ACT III

INT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - NIGHT

PARSLEY lands by PYRUS on the dirt.

DJ CAULIFLOWER
We got a Cilantro in da yard!

PARSLEY
And we got a Cauliflower... on
guard?

DJ CAULIFLOWER
Not just a Cauliflower. *The*. DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER holds a microphone towards the patrons.

"DIRT ON YOU" SONG

PARSLEY
Holy sneezeworts. It's DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER
What are you all, houseplants?! You
know who I am, Dirty City! We gotta
act like weeds all up in dis
cement. Me, I'm a godsend...

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)
WE DA BEST...

PYRUS
WE ARE BEST...

DJ CAULIFLOWER
WE DA BEST...

PARSLEY & PYRUS
WE ARE BEST FRIENDS!

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D)
WE DA BEST HOUSEPLANTS!

PARSLEY
IT'S DJ...?

PARSLEY & PYRUS
IT'S DJ...

DJ CAULIFLOWER
DJ CAULIFLOWERRRR!

PYRUS
I love this song!

PARSLEY
Which one? DJ Cauliflower starts
every song like-

PYRUS
Don't make me squash ya into pesto,
Cilantro.

LET'S GET DIRTY!
LET'S GET DIRTY, PARSLEY?

PARSLEY
YOU GET DIRTY, PYRUS.

PYRUS
PLEASE GET DIRTY WITH ME.

PYRUS drags PARSLEY to the dance floor.

PARSLEY & PYRUS
LET'S GET DIRTY!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT
ON YOU, ON YOU.
YOU GOTTA LOTTA NERVES COMING HERE.

PYRUS hands liqueur to PARSLEY, which he incrementally
drinks.

PARSLEY
WITH YOUR B S!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT
ON YOU, ON YOU.
YOU... I'M KEEPING MY EYES ON YOUR

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D) PARSLEY & PYRUS
DIRTY SOIL! FILTHY SOIL!

PARSLEY
LET'S GET DIRTY!

PYRUS
YA SO DIRTY TO ME!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
Y'ALL GET DIRTY!

PARSLEY & PYRUS
YOU: I GOT, I GOT DIRT
ON YOU, ON YOU.
YOU... I'M KEEPING MY EYES ON YOUR
DIRTY SOIL!

The lake forms. The tides rise.

DJ CAULIFLOWER
DO NOT MESS AROUND BECAUSE MY ROOTS
ARE IN DA UNDERGROUND.
IF YOU STUCK AROUND, WE'LL HAVE
YOUR STEMS MAKING MUDDY WET SOUNDS.

PARSLEY & PYRUS
ROOT FOR ME
AND WATER ME!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
SOIL ME!

Give me dat freaking money!

PYRUS makes money rain.

PARSLEY
Money screwed over my mom!

PYRUS
We're screwing every adult in Dirty
City!

PARSLEY
What's dirty?

PYRUS
Dirty City... Where ya live? Are ya
drunk...?

PARSLEY
I never felt so aliveeee!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
Dat little herb is on their own
little island!

Rainstorms brew. The stormy ocean descends and washes PYRUS
away. A lighthouse appears. PARSLEY's sea legs break. His
fears swallow him.

PARSLEY
CAN A, CAN A PLANT DROWN?

DJ CAULIFLOWER
IF WATER REACHES OUR STEMS, WE IN
TROUBLE.
WHEN DA BAR AIN'T YOURS, TIME
BEHIND BARS IS DOUBLED!

PARSLEY
DOUBLED?!

PYRUS (O.S.)
I NEED YOU...
YOU NEED TO...
I NEED TO...
I NEED TWO BARS OF REST!

DJ CAULIFLOWER stops the music as PYRUS searches in blinding
light.

PYRUS (CONT'D) PARSLEY
Parsley! Parsley! Py- Pesto-

PARSLEY pukes. DJ CAULIFLOWER resumes the music.

DJ CAULIFLOWER
Dat's real dirt, did someone get
dat on tape?

The lighthouse turns into cameras.

PYRUS
Malus is my unty! Ugh. You're good
as dirt, hanging out with all the
grapes.

DJ CAULIFLOWER
Excuse me. All my hype men are
homemade! Now, someone compost dat
on all social medias!

DO NOT MESS AROUND BECAUSE MY ROOTS
ARE IN DA UNDERGROUND.
NOW YOU'VE STUCK AROUND, WE'LL HAVE
YOUR STEMS IMPOUND, IMPOUND,
IMPOUND!

PYRUS reaches PARSLEY.

The cameras morph into ambulances.

PYRUS
DIRT'S ON YA...

PARSLEY
AND DIRT'S ON YOU...

DJ CAULIFLOWER
CALL DA COPS!

PARSLEY & PYRUS
COPS?!

DJ CAULIFLOWER
YOU: WE GOT, WE GOT DIRT
ON BOTH OF YOU.
YOU GOTTA LOTTA NERVES DRINKING
HERE.

PYRUS
THIS IS BULL CRAP!

PYRUS throws money all about. They drag away PARSLEY.

The ambulance lights morph into police lights and sirens.

DJ CAULIFLOWER
YOU: WE GOT, WE GOT DIRT
ON YOU, YOU, YOU...
TWO... ARE NOT ABLE TO WIGGLE

DJ CAULIFLOWER (CONT'D) PARSLEY & PYRUS
YOUR WAY OUTTA DIS! THERE'S DIRT ON US!

Handcuffs are audible.

END OF "DIRT ON YOU"

EXT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - LONG AGO

"FIG LEAF" SONG

Shadows are present, reminiscent of the Vietnam War era.

MALUS (V.O.)

A tree's lifetime ago, in the suburb of Dirty City by the banks of Lily River, there birthed an Apple named Malus. Their birthday was on the winter solstice, the shortest day of the year known as the founding of FigLeaf.

Dat was an extraordinary day. My parents kicked me out. I laid naked on the concrete, freezing to death. An Orange found me. They sheltered me here in this nightclub. Figs flocked from all over the world to meet this miracle.

But something stark happened: a Cilantro walked into the bar. A post-traumatic memory revisited the Orange. The Orange was an agent who fought in the war on the Cilantro's home turf. Orange faced endless horrors as swarms of herbs stood their ground despite the chemical fires. Orange gave me their deed and left into the moonlight.

I used to eclipse my light. I once hid my life. FigLeaf gave me the might to show my light. I require the cross pollinations of the bees and bees... They bequeath me queer peace.

I live for the science of FigLeaf. With sugar and water, I took over its forces of nature. I, however, did not teach Pyrus to respect it.

As was the winter solstice the birth of FigLeaf, the summer solstice is the end of FigLeaf.

END OF "FIG LEAF"

EXT. FIGLEAF NIGHTCLUB - PRESENT

RAU drags in MALUS and slaps them. She cannot find the words.

MALUS

You've lost the plot. *Thang chó đe*
(*taun cha deh; Vietnamese: "Son of*
a insult"). Dat's me.

RAU

Face the consequences of not
looking after Pyru-

MALUS

You face it. It's in your
chlorophyll. Your kind spilled *red*
blood. Your family is invasive.

RAU

Invasive?! You deranged- Annoying
orange-

MALUS

Don't compare Crabapples to
Oranges! Pyrus said Parsley was as
yellow as the sun. The hospital's at
least making sure he ain't end up in
the sky.

RAU hands some money to MALUS.

MALUS (CONT'D)

This ain't fixing the *blues*.

RAU

This will at least fix the bill for
all the *indigo* cocktails my Parsley
didn't pay for.

MALUS

This is some B S, you shrinking
violet.

RAU

The *greens*. Doesn't that solve
everything?

MALUS

Don't put it on me to answer to you
anymore.

RAU

Then put it on the house-

MALUS

There won't be a house.

RAU

It's you who lost the plot...? Not FigLeaf...

MALUS

Dirty City is shutting us down.
They got *proof*.

RAU

In the liqueur pumping out my son's
stoma...

MALUS

Underage drinking... Perpetrated-
Encouraged by my blood. Why didn't
my nibling card your kid?

RAU

That pear hasn't earned their adult
card, yet.

MALUS

And you ain't ever earned any of
yours!

RAU

I get it: my earnings are zero-

MALUS

Get it to your aldehyde: look
beyond the green B S and B S cards.

RAU

Parsley will wither as my brother
and I have.

MALUS

You bring him up every time you
want to pretend to relate to Figs
cause you had a gay brother. There
ain't a thing you can do for the
dead.

RAU

Hmm. What do you have to say for
your sister?

MALUS

FigLeaf was the chance to get her
child out of trouble and make their
plot feel whole.

RAU

FigLeaf is now a plot hole... But,
I do recall a Fig who once sang:
"move the plot forward."

MALUS

Move the plot forward, not move my
plots out. You took my job away.
Invasive species-

RAU

What's left to say, *houseplant*?

MALUS

Dirty City's verdict was right.
Immigrants come here to take away
our jobs, homes, and lives.

RAU

They got dirt on both of us!

MALUS

Being queer or foreign ain't the
same struggle. Do not plant us in
the same patch of soil.

RAU

You Crabapples did it first for us.

MALUS

Spare me the details.

RAU

It is on me to pass on to you the
card up my sleeve. We're more in
common than you can ever imagine.
It comes with revoking our
greens...

"GREEN CARD" SONG

MALUS

YOU WERE LAYING ON MY YARD...
THEY HAD LEFT YOU STARVING.
I SHOULD'VE KEPT MY GUARD
BEFORE YOU KILLED MY GREEN CARD!

RAU

I HOLD A REAL GREEN CAR-

MALUS

IM LANG ("EEM LAUNG")!

YOUR WORDS WILL NOT GO SO FAR...
(MORE)

MALUS (CONT'D)
THEY SHOULD HAVE JUST BARRED YOU.
I USED TO STOP SPARS.
NOW, THEY WENT AND CLOSED MY BAR!

RAU	MALUS (CONT'D)
SORRY.	
I DESERVE NO GREEN CARD.	YOUR HAND DESERVES A BAD CARD.
I HAVE SERVED YOU ENDLESS	THEY SAW YOU AS JARRING.
SCARS.	YOU ARE UNNATURAL.
WHICH IS BY FAR NATURALLY	YOU'LL NEVER CHANGE WHO YOU
QUEER AS YOU ARE.	ARE!

MALUS (CONT'D)
'SCUSE ME?

RAU feels the potted herb.

RAU
BROTHER...

Leaves fall from above, and land in RAU's hand.

RAU (CONT'D)
The new leaves- The next generation
will turn this world upside down
for the better.

RAU (CONT'D)	MALUS
YOU AND PYRUS CAME SO FAR...	YOU ARE GOING TOO FAR.
THEY CAN STILL GET STARTED.	MY PYRUS IS A REAL STAR.
I NEED TO GROW SMART.	IMMIGRANTS NEVER SETTLE
MY TURN TO HAVE A HEART.	FOR LOW MARKS.

RAU (CONT'D)
REPORT CARDS, BUSINESS CARDS,
DON'T GET ME STARTED ON CREDIT
CARDS.
TAKE THEM ALL!
THE TAKEAWAY IS THAT GREEN CARDS
ARE EARNED...
I MUST WATER OUR COMMUNITY.
IT'S THE LEAST I CAN DO.

END OF "GREEN CARD"

MALUS
You took away my rights.

RAU
They almost took my son's life.

MALUS
Pyrus gave your son life.

MALUS hands the photo of the pear and cilantro to RAU.

RAU
Malus, you gave me life.

MALUS
You took away my livelihood.

RAU
You can start over.

MALUS
The queer community I built?!

RAU
You can always hide it under your soil. And wait to reveal yourself when the light is right.

MALUS
So hide in the soil again is what you saying?

RAU
Many plants want the chance to start over. To turn back into the seeds.

MALUS
Save your false wisdom in the closet.

RAU
I have every politician in my closet.

MALUS
More like skeletons- Wait, what?

RAU
Same thing. Representatives from across the nation come to Salontro. When they get comfortable, they'll tell me anything.

MALUS
Elaborate...?

RAU
Remember that "Morning Wood" scandal on WoodTV8?

MALUS
From Loyal Oak, the city over?

RAU

Their mayor shorted me. So, I was the anonymous tip who revealed their adultery on the news station's live Q&A with Mayor Pumpkin Eater.

MALUS

And *cheater Pumpkin Eater* resigned. So for you, *politics be nasty*. You Cilantros are indoctrina-

RAU

I also built relationships with the investor and management community, grooming returns based on the size of their emotional transactions.

MALUS

Sick. You've got dirt on everyone. What about the council in our hometown?

RAU

Dirty City did me dirty. They lined my pockets with tax cuts. But, they won't do more. *Though, I got neighboring cities in my pockets for you!*

MALUS

I don't matter. Pyrus does. Pyrus is going to be in bigger trouble without me in the plot.

RAU

I'm moving Pyrus's plot forward.

MALUS

There's the usual backwards reasoning you do.

RAU

I'm giving back to a lost soul what you've gave this lost immigrant. I've held everyone back. I'm a houseplant...

MALUS

You're a transplant.

RAU

I'm a transplant...

MALUS

A plant who transforms...

RAU

A plant who transforms...

MALUS

The environment around them...

RAU

The environment around me...

MALUS

You do not belong on this soil. But your blood altered the chemistry of it, so that Pyrus can feel even more welcomed. Your son changed them.

RAU

Parsley got a new friend, too... My parents tried to stop my brother Cori from changing with his circle. Cori Anh Der crawled through the mud, so that Parsley can trail ahead.

MALUS

A young Cilantro once said: "mud is where you're most safe."

MALUS unveils mud underneath. An olive branch hangs. RAU hugs MALUS.

RAU

A real friend's here when the B S hits the fan.

MALUS

Hey... Where did this olive branch come from? You hug like a tree hugger. Dat is so gay.

RAU humorously detaches.

RAU

Take my money. You'll need it more than I do. Huh... Will I ever earn my green card?

MALUS

Dat's not for us geezers to decide.

RAU
That's for the...

RAU & MALUS
Second generation of seedlings.

RAU
Malus, go out there and save
another Cilantro!

MALUS floats off into the sunrise.

RAU (CONT'D)
I knew it, I knew it: Figs are
angels.

RAU finally plants herself. She buries her hands in the mud.
She transforms, pulling out her palms now drenched in green.
RAU has earned her green card.

RAU (CONT'D)
YOU ARE... A NATURAL.

INT. PYRUS'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

ANCHOR (O.S.)
A defiant cilantro is an
international sensation overnight.
Despite

PARSLEY
She's gonna wilt if she doesn't
stop *this instant*.

PYRUS
Do you need a ride?

INT. FIGLEAF - DAY

RAU, deathly dehydrated and starved, is barely holding on.
She holds a photo of PARSLEY and PYRUS.

EXT. FIGLEAF - DAY

The bus arrives in front of the protest. PARSLEY, PYRUS, and
BOMBUS get off.

PYRUS
You're the best!

BUS DRIVER

Happy to drop you off for the good
of the community, not because
you're in trouble. Keep it up.

PARSLEY

Will you keep it up?

PYRUS

Nope. Get outta the way, *community*!

PARSLEY is baffled by the crowd size. But PYRUS doesn't care.
PYRUS shoves the crowd around to let PARSLEY through until
they reach the police line. They cannot pass the COPS.

INT. FIGLEAF - DAY

We see the photo of PARSLEY and PYRUS.

PARSLEY (O.S.)

Me (Vietnamese: "Mom")!

The photo lowers. BOMBUS is lifting the KIDS at the window.

RAU

*Con trai (Vietnamese: "Son")... and
Pyrus...*

The COPS remove BOMBUS and the KIDS from the window.

RAU urgently uproots. Nearing the door, it's as though it's
been forever since she felt the sun and her son. She exits.

EXT. FIGLEAF - DAY

When RAU is in view, the crowd goes silent.

RHIZO and DANDY arrive, pleasantly surprised at RAU's exit.

DANDY

When their roots leave FigLeaf's
ground, we do not need this deal.

The COPS let RAU through.

RAU hugs PARSLEY.

RHIZO laughs as DANDY rips up the compromise agreement.

RHIZO

(Through a radio)
Bar the soap! Bar the soap!

The COPS grab ahold of RAU, causing an uproar.

BOMBUS buzzes into a COP's radio, expelling a high pitch buzz.

PYRUS nabs a PROTESTOR's megaphone.

PYRUS

(Through the megaphone)
Plants of the law. When did you
kids grow up to be hall monitors?
Isn't it your job to protect
property? The property that have
provided you refuge. I've seen many
of you be your true selves here.
I've seen you all fabulous.

Many COPS blush.

PYRUS (CONT'D)

You will amount to anything...

The COPS let go of RAU. They side with the PROTESTORS.

DANDY barks out orders to the BULLDOZER DRIVER.

DANDY

Uproot this alliance!

BULLDOZER DRIVER

Look, uprooting a community-led
peaceful gathering is one thing.
But cops. I'm a transplant-

RHIZO hears the DRIVER say that they're a transplant.

DANDY forces out the DRIVER. They take control.

The crowds wildly disperse.

The bulldozer does not bulldoze. It instead extends a giant
trowel, uproots the FigLeaf building and flips it upside down.

RAU sobs at the sight of destruction. PYRUS is shocked.

PARSLEY holds her hand. He sees they're vermillion again.

PARSLEY

You lost your green card?

RAU

Coming into Woodwork... was all for
nothing!

PARSLEY

We can still protect Salontro.
Vamos!

PYRUS
Bombus. Send reinforcement!

BOMBUS flies off.

RAU, PARSLEY, and PYRUS head inside Salontro.

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

2 CSP AGENTS arrive.

RHIZO pulls green gloves off the BULLDOZER DRIVER. They see non-green hands.

RHIZO
Don't want to get my leaves dirty.

RHIZO approaches the emboldened DANDY in the bulldozer.

DANDY
We're also targeting Salontro?! Am
I gonna get a two for one deal
today or what?

RHIZO
I need a word with you about
your... *transgression*.

RHIZO and the 2 CSP AGENTS approach Salontro.

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

RAU, PARSLEY, and PYRUS see the CSP squad approach.

INT. RAU'S STUDY IN SALONTRO - DAY

RHIZO enters.

RAU
Your mom is ashamed of you!

RHIZO
You don't know them.

RAU
You're a child of transplants?

RHIZO
My twin was friends with invasive-

RAU
You'd make friends too if you don't
insult them.

RHIZO

What hurts more than insults is
silence.

RHIZO handcuff RAU.

RHIZO (CONT'D)

You have the right to remain
silence. Not remain here.

RHIZO sees a polaroid camera with a photo protruding.

FLASH! RHIZO is blinded.

BOMBUS knocks out RHIZO.

MALUS comes out of the shadows, holding an external camera
button. The backdoor is open.

MALUS

You need the keys back?

RAU

The angel came back right on time.
How were you so stealthy?

MALUS

Agent Orange taught me a thing or
two.

INT. SALONTRO - SHORTLY AFTER

MALUS shoves RHIZO into a tanning bed.

From inside the tanning bed, RHIZO sees the light.

BEGIN FLASHBACK

Teenage TRANSPLANTS with non-green hands beat up 8-year-old
RHIZO. CANNA stops the bullies.

That night, their MOTHER hold RHIZO's head high with her non-
green hands. Their MOTHER heals RHIZO's wounds with light.

END FLASHBACK

CANNA opens the tanning bed, preparing to fight.

RHIZO hugs CANNA.

CANNA

I came to talk some sense into you.
Is that no longer necessary?

RHIZO
I saw the light.

RAU has the photo of RHIZO taken earlier.

RAU
Here's your before photo. Would you
like an after one?

RHIZO shakes RAU's hand.

FLASH!

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

RHIZO and CANNA exit. RHIZO carries their before photo and an
after photo with RAU.

DANDY prepares to drive the bulldozer into Salontro.

DANDY
Perfect that your twin got you out.
I was worried about you, Rhizo.

RHIZO
I'm worried about you, Dandy. And
your invasive species.

CANNA
Transplants.

RHIZO
How many transplants is your
company harboring and exploiting?

DANDY
That's what you meant by
"transgression..."

The 2 gleaming CSP AGENTS handcuff DANDY.

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

RAU
I'm sorry I couldn't save Fig-

MALUS
(Motioning to PYRUS)
Save it- your energy for what
matters most.

PYRUS
I don't amount to anything.

PARSLEY taps PYRUS.

RAU rolls her eyes and looks at the cash register.

RAU
I didn't finish. I'm sorry that I
couldn't save old FigLeaf. I could
save you a spot for a new one.

RAU, PARSLEY, PYRUS, MALUS, and BOMBUS embrace.

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

MALUS (O.S.)
Who'd have thought a cilantro could
lose any more weight?

RAU (O.S.)
Sounds like you don't need a poor
defenseless cilantro's help anymore-

MALUS (O.S.)
Wait, wait, wait!

FigLeaf is completely demolished next to Salontro.

MATCH CUT TO:

EXT. SALONTRO - DAY

TEXT: END OF THE SUMMER.

FigLeaf is being rebuilt.

INT. SALONTRO - DAY

RAU looks out at the construction then checks the salon.

Business is dead. The salon is like a dead houseplant.

RAU checks the cash register and pulls out a single bill.

PYRUS
What's wrong, Ms. Ram?

RAU
A slow day. A good problem to have.

PYRUS
Like me?

PARSLEY

PARSLEY (O.S.) (CONT'D)
Can I turn the sign to "open?"

RAU
I'm open for business. You are not.
Stay in bed.

PARSLEY (O.S.)
At least I'm in a bed, not a
coffin. Like that joke, mom? *Me*
(Vietnamese: "Mom")...

RAU
Me (Vietnamese: "Mom") as in "meh"
or "me?"

PARSLEY (O.S.)
Vietnamese words are funny.

RAU
Especially Vietnamese plants.

PARSLEY (O.S.)
Mostly the Cilantros's musical
taste.

RAU
Hey. Wash your mouth out with soap.

PARSLEY pops out of a tanning bed, holding soap.

PARSLEY
(to the camera)
Raise your appendages if we,
Cilantros, taste like soap!

PARSLEY hands soaps to the camera.

PARSLEY (CONT'D)
This is your next meal. Let me know
if we really taste like that.

RAU
You talking to nobody and wasting
our soap does not make a good case
for you being "well."

PYRUS (O.S.)
And I have a bad case ahead of me.

PYRUS enters. Their skin holds minor burns.

RAU
Pyrus... In the flesh.

PYRUS

I certainly don't look fresh, Ms.
Răm.

RAU

Summer's coming to an end. But
there's light at the end of the
tunnel as you return to school.

PYRUS

I need school, so I don't end up a
"đồ vô học" ("dough vo how"; Viet:
"An uneducated person").

PARSLEY

Me (Vietnamese: "Mom"), you're the
one who needs to be educated.

RAU nods in agreement.

PYRUS

Sorry for calling ya an invader.

RAU

I'm sorry to invade your space.

PYRUS

Enlighten me.

RAU

There is more to darkness than
meets the eyes.

PYRUS

FigLeaf was the only light in the
nightlife.

RAU

I'm sorry your unty has to start
over.

PYRUS

I'm glad he helped you get started.
It's ya turn to give Malus the
tips.

RAU gives PYRUS the last money bill.

RAU

I'll give you one: to my son, say
good-

PYRUS

Goodbye. I know... *Good riddance?*

RAU

Goodness gracious. Have something
good to say. Stop being the root
cause. Be the root effect.

PYRUS

Little herb... I... Sor-

PARSLEY

Breathe in, breathe out... Um, 6
carbon... 12 hydrogen... 6
oxygen...

PYRUS

Plus 6 oxygen molecules...

PARSLEY & PYRUS

Photosynthesis. Photosynthesis.
Photosynthesis! I will always root
for you.

PYRUS

I will never amount to anything. I
won't mount a proper apology. But
for once, I do care. This is
despair. Don't look at this pear.

PARSLEY

You always amount to everything.

PYRUS hands a crop top to PARSLEY.

PYRUS

Don't puke on this one, okay?

PARSLEY

And don't let the flowers bully
you!

PYRUS

Ah, another school year at THC.
I'll climb high on a mountain.

RAU

I'm sorry things worked out the way
they did. But you can. Make sure
you grab a tax form on your way
out!

As MALUS had done for RAU, RAU moves a plot of land for
PYRUS.

PYRUS

Taxes?

RAU
You must pay the government B S to
work.

PYRUS
What you're saying is a load of B
S.

RAU
Well, you're old enough to intern.
And that B S you pocketed is your
first paycheck.

PYRUS
Why?

RAU
I owe your unty.

PYRUS
I'd probably get the salon shut
down, too.

PARSLEY
Oh shut up, poop head.

"TURNOVER (A NEW LEAF)" SONG

PARSLEY hugs PYRUS.

PYRUS
I'd be supervised by *dat*? I'll
clean dat dirt in ya mouth, ya
sweetgrass.

RAU
Finally, someone else up for the
task.

PYRUS
I cannot thank you enough, Ms. Răm.

RAU
It's my *turn* to help you start
over.

PARSLEY
You're welcome back any time!

RAU
With Malus's intent, there's always
a plot for you here.

RAU opens a colorful tanning bed, where PYRUS sits.

MALUS gets out of another tanning bed. They watch as PYRUS gleams. There are hints they opened a new nightclub called "Fig Garden."

MALUS
TURN AROUND!

Business is booming again with patrons coming in and out.

PARSLEY & PYRUS
WE HAVE CHANGED THEM.
TURN OVER PAIRS OF FRESH EYES.
NEW LEAVES, COLORS.
TURN OVER TO THIS STRANGE LIGHT.

RAU & MALUS
LIGHT.

PARSLEY, RAU, PYRUS, MALUS
THIS DIRTY CITY IS OUR HOME.
THE NEIGHBORS, THEY'RE KNOWN
TO HELP US TO SOW OUR SEEDS AND
GROW...
TURN OVER AND CHANGE FOR THE
BETTER.

Water rains down.

PARSLEY & RAU	PYRUS & MALUS
THIS IS THE SPARK OF...	THIS IS THE SPARK OF...
A FLORAL PARTNERSHIP.	AN HERBAL PARTNERSHIP.
A FRIENDSHIP WHERE I CAN REST	A FRIENDSHIP THAT LEAVES THE
OUR GARDEN.	BEST SHARED GARDEN.

PARSLEY and PYRUS turn the "Closed" sign to "Open."

PARSLEY, RAU, MALUS, PYRUS
BUT THE BEST TURNOVER WE'VE HAD IS
THE SUN!

A tanning bed opens with sunlight.

END OF "TURNOVER (A NEW LEAF)"

CANNA enters.

CANNA
(to the camera)
We hope you enjoyed your stay in
Dirty City. Now, let's let these
plants bow to the light. Oh, I get
the last bow. And before you return
to your home garden, let's take a
group photo!

"BOW - PHOTOSYNTHESIS" SONG

COMPANY
PHOTOSYNTHESIS! PHOTOSYNTHESIS!
PHOTO!

END OF "BOW - PHOTOSYNTHESIS"

FLASH! The polaroid camera prints out a group photo. This is the photo RAU has wanted ever since her lonely photo in the CSP Office.

Below reads the end title: **PHOTOSYNTHESIS**

END OF THE PLOT

CREDITS

**DEDICATION: DEDICATED TO HUE NGOC NGUYEN, PHOTOGRAPHER AND
DAVID QUANG PHAM'S MOM**

